

Anthony Drane

Principal Product & Service Designer | Transformation | Complex Systems | Strategy

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CAREER PROFILE

Strategic and analytical Principal Designer with 8+ years of end-to-end experience helping organisations turn ambiguous, interconnected, and complex problems into coherent products, services and strategies that can be validated and implemented. Expertise in shaping initiatives across state government and private sector environments, delivering evidence-based digital innovation, legacy system modernisation, service transformation, emerging technology and continuous improvement projects.

Combines senior design leadership with hands-on problem solving; utilising business goals, customer and operational insight, systems thinking, strategic facilitation, initiative governance and future-state design to create alignment, enable informed decisions and translate uncertainty into actionable direction, value and impact. Increasingly focused on leveraging AI and new technologies to re-envision how products and services are conceived, validated and delivered.

Core Capabilities

Discovery & Problem Framing • Design & Systems Thinking • Primary & Secondary Research • Product & Service Strategy • Complex Ecosystem Modelling & Service Transformation • Future-state Ideation, Co-Design & Validation • Initiative Planning & Prioritisation • Leadership, Alignment & Decision-Making • Design Definition & Delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SafeWork NSW

Jun 2025 – present

Sydney, Australia

Principal Service Designer (Contract)

Early-stage discovery, transformation and design leadership role for a major systems modernisation program, shaping future-state products, services and operating models within a complex regulatory ecosystem.

- Co-led phased discovery across 30+ teams and 65+ workflows - supporting 400+ staff - shaping discovery planning and execution, research, current-state understanding, pain-point and opportunity identification, requirements and future-state ideation.
- Developed and presented visual concepts and future-state artefacts for procurement and executive audiences, achieving ELT support and prioritisation, plus organisational engagement and feedback for the upcoming transformation.
- Co-designed and re-engineered future-state processes, system and experience decisions across business analysis, service design and data disciplines, including foundational entity and information structures supporting the future-state system.
- Designed and validated a future approach to historically sufficient legacy entity information, exploring data migration constraints, information prioritisation and use-case inclusions/exclusions to inform a viable migration/transition strategy.
- Established design principles, research and decision-making practices, including a research repository, decision and assumption logs, research templates and documentation architecture to strengthen team consistency and traceability.
- Led the simplification and alignment around a repeatable minimum viable design and process re-engineering approach, including standardised JIRA templates, enabling continued multidisciplinary activity under reduced resourcing.

- Undertook contextual design research across major operational roles, synthesising observations into findings, recommendations and opportunities to inform future-state workflow and a coherent experience design direction.
- **Upcoming:** Undertaking the functional design of a Salesforce POC, translating future-state service and process concepts into working system configurations, prototypes and experiments to evaluate platform capabilities and design options.

Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

Senior Service Designer (Contract)

Contributed to the generation of a systems modernisation business case alongside the conducting of discovery research, field studies, strategy workshops and SME sessions, producing a vision statement, insights, current-state scenarios and RFI questions.

Service NSW

Apr 2021 – Jan 2025

Sydney, Australia

Senior Product Designer (Mobile App)

Senior/Principal role leading product, strategy and service design initiatives, including foundational patterns and pilot delivery for the emerging/disruptive technology of verifiable credentials.

- Led end-to-end design within one of two digital and verifiable credential squads, translating ambiguous product goals into research, strategy, UX/UI, prototyping, testing and delivery in close partnership with Product, Engineering and QA.
- Delivered major credential experiences including Working With Children Check verification, Digital Driver Licence capabilities, Trade Licences and the COVID-19 Certificate, working with agency partners and increasing digital adoption.
- Designed the primary patterns and user flows of the Verifiable Credential (VC) MVP, creating the personal-app experience for credential issuance, management, lifecycle & verification as demonstrated to government and industry stakeholders at Austroads IVC 2024 and later piloted with the Photo Card at Service Centres.
- Independently undertook strategic design initiatives including a pre-VC credential-sharing strategy that connected consumer and business product streams; a strategic assessment for where future VC verification should reside for scalability and uptake; VC service ecosystem interactions in different contexts-of-use; and VC behavioural strategies to manage transitional co-existence with legacy credentials.
- Acted twice as Principal Designer with four reports, providing design direction, backlog prioritisation, delivery oversight and mentoring; orchestrating a major app reskin and the delivery of wallet management via a dedicated bottom navigation.
- Received 'Make it Happen' award for rapid prototype delivery of a 'workplace adjustment passport' concept for the 'Let's Rock' accessibility conference.
- Participated in two design-practice groups for research and principles/manifesto.

Feb 2020 – Mar 2021

Sydney, Australia

Senior Product Designer (Website)

Generative discovery and continuous improvement role; adding features, enhancements and experimental innovations to improve access to government services and the user experience of the Service NSW website.

- Led research and design of the MVP internal GEL (design system) website and information architecture, enabling all designers and engineers to discover and consume styles, components and usage/content guidance.
- Re-designed the COVID-19 information hub based on customer research, increasing findability and reducing avoidable contact-centre enquiries.
- Spearheaded personalisation experimentation work to optimise experiences, piloting location-relevant homepages for Service Centres and disaster relief zones.
- Optimised website search through analysis of customer language and search behaviour, improving query accuracy and the findability of information and services.

	Contributed components and accessibility improvements to the GEL including font scaling, nested accordions, enriched search results and location finder.
Jun 2018 – Feb 2020 Sydney, Australia	Link Group / MUFG <i>UX Designer</i> Internal UX consultant across investor websites, web applications, internal systems and mobile products within Link Group's financial services and superannuation businesses. - Led the re-design of 3 core modules of flagship product <i>miraqle</i>, including <i>Ownership</i>; a complex financial investment module supporting 500+ corporate clients which shipped Q1 2020. - Co-designed a 350+ screen white-label superannuation mobile app, establishing reusable UX patterns and supporting adoption and launch by multiple client organisations such as Prime Super. - Designed and delivered end-to-end UX/UI features across a number of financial products, including Member centre, Investor Centre, Fund Management, RoundUps and IPO websites.
Nov 2017 – Mar 2018 Chullora, Australia	ProAuto Group <i>Product Designer (Contract)</i> Individually owned product and service design for a concept platform helping automotive dealers improve road-to-sale workflows, outcomes and generate actionable operational data. - Mapped current-state dealership operations through interviews, contextual inquiry and process analysis, identifying workflow pain points and opportunities for technology-enabled support. - Prioritised the MVP proposition and translated insights into wireframes and interactive prototypes through iterative testing and business feedback. - Developed and pitched the future-state product and service proposition to investors, including a business model canvas and detailed service blueprint for implementation handover.
Feb 2018 – Mar 2018 Manly, Australia	BECOME Education <i>UX/UI Designer (Contract)</i> Designed a set of assistive career-discovery web application concepts to support student-led career exploration. - Synthesised existing research and co-design workshops with founders to establish the organisation's first user personas. - Rapidly translated insights into divergent concepts, user flows, wireframes and MVP and future features.
Nov 2017 Gordon, Australia	City Water Technology <i>UX Consultant (Contract)</i>
2014 – 2018 Artarmon	Channel 9 News <i>Senior Non-Linear Video Editor</i>
2013 – 2014 Artarmon	Channel 9 <i>Media Exchange Operator</i>
2012 – 2013 Bathurst, Australia	2MCE <i>Community Radio Journalist & Presenter</i>

EDUCATION

2023 – 2024	Graduate Certificate in Service Design
Melbourne, Australia	<i>Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology (RMIT)</i> GPA - 3.5 / 4
2017	UX Immersive
Sydney, Australia	<i>General Assembly</i>
2011 – 2013	Bachelor of Communication (Journalism)
Bathurst, Australia	<i>Charles Sturt University (CSU)</i>
2004 – 2009	High School Certificate
Sydney	<i>SHORE school</i> Bands 5 & 6

COURSES

2024	Agile core ceremonies
	<i>Service NSW</i>
2023	Designing for Accessibility
	<i>Intopia</i>
2022	Human-Centred Systems Thinking
	<i>IDEOU</i>
2022	Workshop Facilitation
	<i>Andy Polaine</i>
2020	Google Analytics 360
	<i>Lens 10</i>
2018	Human Computer Interaction
	<i>University Georgia Tech (via Coursera)</i>
2017	Object-oriented Programming
	<i>University of Helsinki</i>
2017	Front-end Development
	<i>FreeCodeCamp</i>
2016	Inspiring Leadership with Emotional Intelligence
	<i>Case Western Reserve University (via Coursera)</i>
2016	Learning How to Learn
	<i>University of San Diego (via Coursera)</i>

TOOLS

Digital Whiteboards (Miro, FigJam) • Figma • AI tools (various) • Atlassian suite (JIRA, Confluence) • Adobe CC (AI, PS, AE, PR) • Notion/Logseq/Obsidian • Slack/Teams • Askable • Qualtrics • Fullstory • Optimal Workshop • Google Analytics • Developer Tools (HTML, CSS & basic JS)